

Proposal for Emoji: Liver

Submitter: Shuhan He

Main point of contact: Shuhan He

Date: 2026-07-24

Identification

Suggested name: Liver

Suggested keywords: hepatic; anatomy; organ; bile; digestion; abdomen; lobes

Suggested category: People & Body body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

The paradigm uses a broad asymmetric outline, unequal lobes, and a gallbladder cue beneath the inferior edge. The 18x18 versions strengthen the lobe boundary and gallbladder/notch rather than relying on fine anatomy that disappears at emoji size. Vendors may vary color and surface detail while preserving those cues.

I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original work created for this proposal, that I own all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text. I release the images under the CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

CC0 1.0: <https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/zero/1.0/>

Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Not applicable. The proposal relies on the literal organ, not an uncited metaphorical, cultural, or symbolic meaning.

B. Use in sequences

Not applicable. This proposal does not claim positive weight for speculative or uncited sequences.

C. Breaks new ground

Yes. No current emoji identifies the liver. Anatomical Heart and Stomach represent different organs. Cut of Meat and Beans represent food categories and do not identify anatomy. Hospital, pill, test tube, warning, and beverage sequences can show surrounding contexts but cannot specify which organ is meant. Liver therefore adds a distinct literal building block rather than a directional, stylistic, or subtype variant.

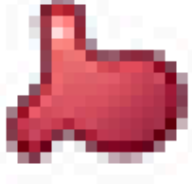
The gap is concrete in ordinary literal messages: “my liver tests were abnormal,” “the scan found a liver lesion,” and “liver anatomy homework.” A test tube, warning, scan, book, or generic medical symbol can convey part of each context, but none identifies the organ being discussed. The candidate supplies that missing body-site reference without purporting to encode the test result, diagnosis, or school subject.

The National Cancer Institute defines the liver as a large organ in the upper abdomen and describes its right and left lobes: <https://www.cancer.gov/publications/dictionaries/cancer-terms/def/liver>

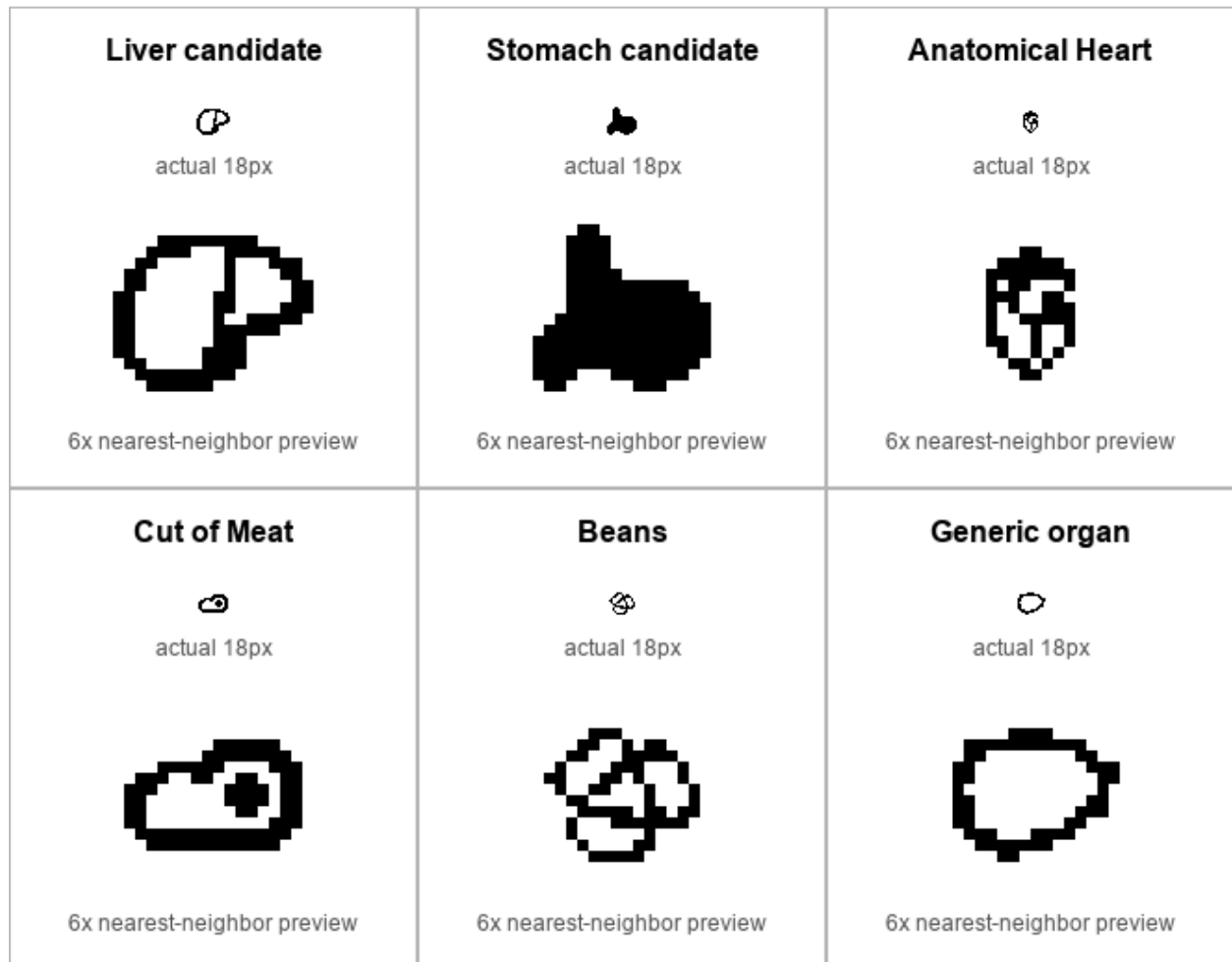
D. Distinctiveness

The candidate uses a wide asymmetric body, a strong division between unequal lobes, and a lower gallbladder cue. Those features separate it from the J-shaped Stomach, the vessel-bearing Anatomical Heart, the bordered Cut of Meat, clustered Beans, and a generic organ blob. The following unprompted-test boards show every target at actual 18x18 size with a nearest-neighbor enlargement for pixel inspection.

Liver visual-confusion board - Color, 18x18 actual size

Liver candidate  actual 18px  6x nearest-neighbor preview	Stomach candidate  actual 18px  6x nearest-neighbor preview	Anatomical Heart  actual 18px  6x nearest-neighbor preview
Cut of Meat  actual 18px  6x nearest-neighbor preview	Beans  actual 18px  6x nearest-neighbor preview	Generic organ  actual 18px  6x nearest-neighbor preview

Liver visual-confusion board - Black and white, 18x18 actual size



The package also contains color and black-and-white 72x72 boards. Human recognition results are not claimed; the prepared unprompted protocol remains an internal gate before publication.

Anatomical Heart, Cut of Meat, and Beans comparison glyphs are designed by OpenMoji and used under CC BY-SA 4.0: <https://openmoji.org/> and <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/>

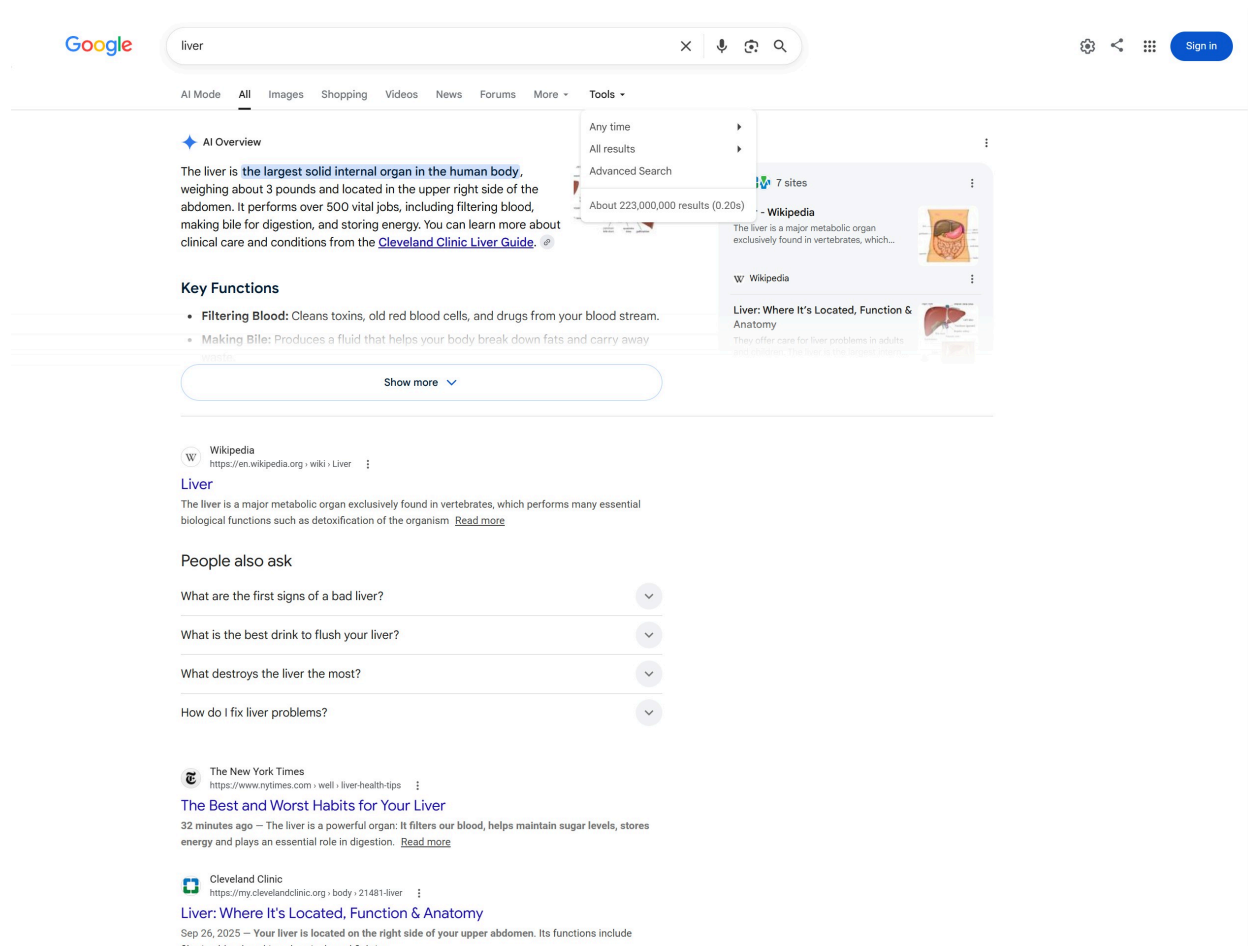
E. Expected usage level

The five required sources are presented below with their exact settings and limitations. The current Worldwide Trends captures, current Ngram capture, current Google Search capture, and current Google Video Search capture establish a complete current frequency package for the literal word.

Google Search

Captured 2026-07-24 using Google's Web-results view. Google's rendered **Tools** control is open in the unmodified screenshot and visibly shows its native total: About 223,000,000 results (0.20s). This volatile count is a dated query snapshot, not a durable usage metric.

Query: <https://www.google.com/search?q=liver&hl=en&num=10&pws=0>



Google Video Search

Captured 2026-07-24 using Google's Video-results view. Google's rendered **Tools** control is open in the unmodified screenshot and visibly shows its native total: About 76,900,000 results (0.20s). This volatile count is a dated query snapshot, not a durable usage metric.

Query: <https://www.google.com/search?udm=7&q=liver&hl=en&num=10&pws=0>

Google

liver

✕ 🔊 🔄 🔍

⚙️ 📱 Sign in

AI Mode All Images Books News Videos Shopping More Tools

www.youtube.com · watch ⓘ

Chronic Liver Disease - Yale Medicine Explains

4:43

For more information on liver disease or #YaleMedicine, visit <https://www.yalemedicine.org/conditions/liver-transplant-or>

YouTube · Yale Medicine · May 2, 2026

3 key moments in this video ▾

www.youtube.com · watch ⓘ

YouTube

2:57

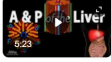
Share your videos with friends, family, and the world.

YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Aug 12, 2024

4 key moments in this video ▾

www.youtube.com · watch ⓘ

Anatomy and Physiology of the Liver, Animation

8:23

the proper hepatic artery carrying oxygenated blood from the aorta, and · the hepatic portal vein carrying venous drainage from most of the ...

YouTube · Allia Medical Media · May 1, 2023

5 key moments in this video ▾

www.youtube.com · watch ⓘ

Liver Patient Education Videos: Video 2 The Liver English

2:20

At Stanford Medicine Children's Health, our team of pediatric liver doctors (hepatologists) are leaders in treating complex pediatric liver ...

YouTube · Stanford Medicine Children's Health · May 30, 2024

www.youtube.com · watch ⓘ

Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors ...

4:11

Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors, Symptoms, Treatment | Mass General Brigham · Comments, Comment... 48:00 · Go to ...

YouTube · Mass General Brigham · Aug 12, 2024

7 key moments in this video ▾

www.youtube.com · watch ⓘ

How to Protect and Treat Your Liver with Dr. Julio Gutierrez ...

Any duration ▸

Any time ▸

Any quality ▸

All videos ▸

Any source ▸

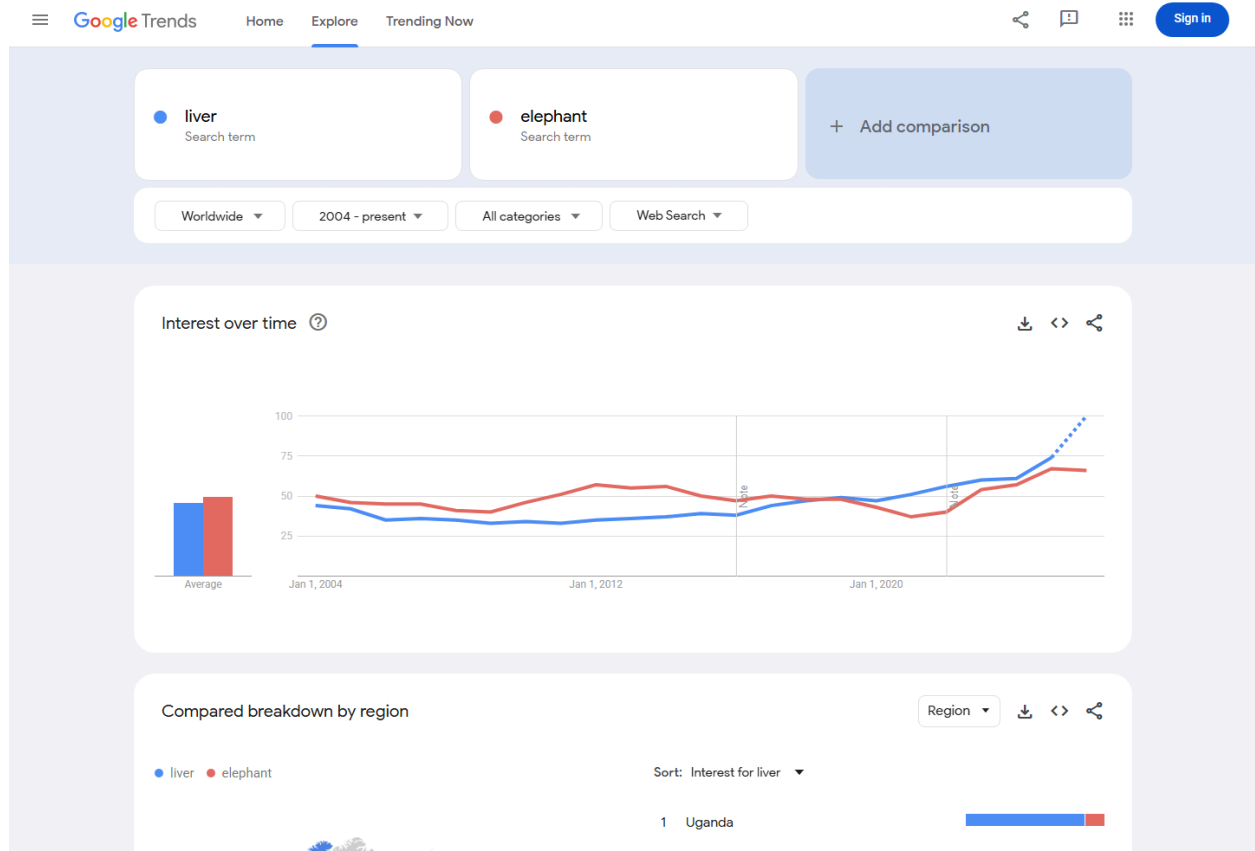
Advanced Search

About 76,900,000 results (0.20s)

Google Trends - Web Search

Captured 2026-07-21 using Worldwide, 2004-present, All categories, and Web Search. The chart's long-run average is 46 for liver and 50 for elephant; liver remains in the same broad range while trailing the comparator slightly over the full period.

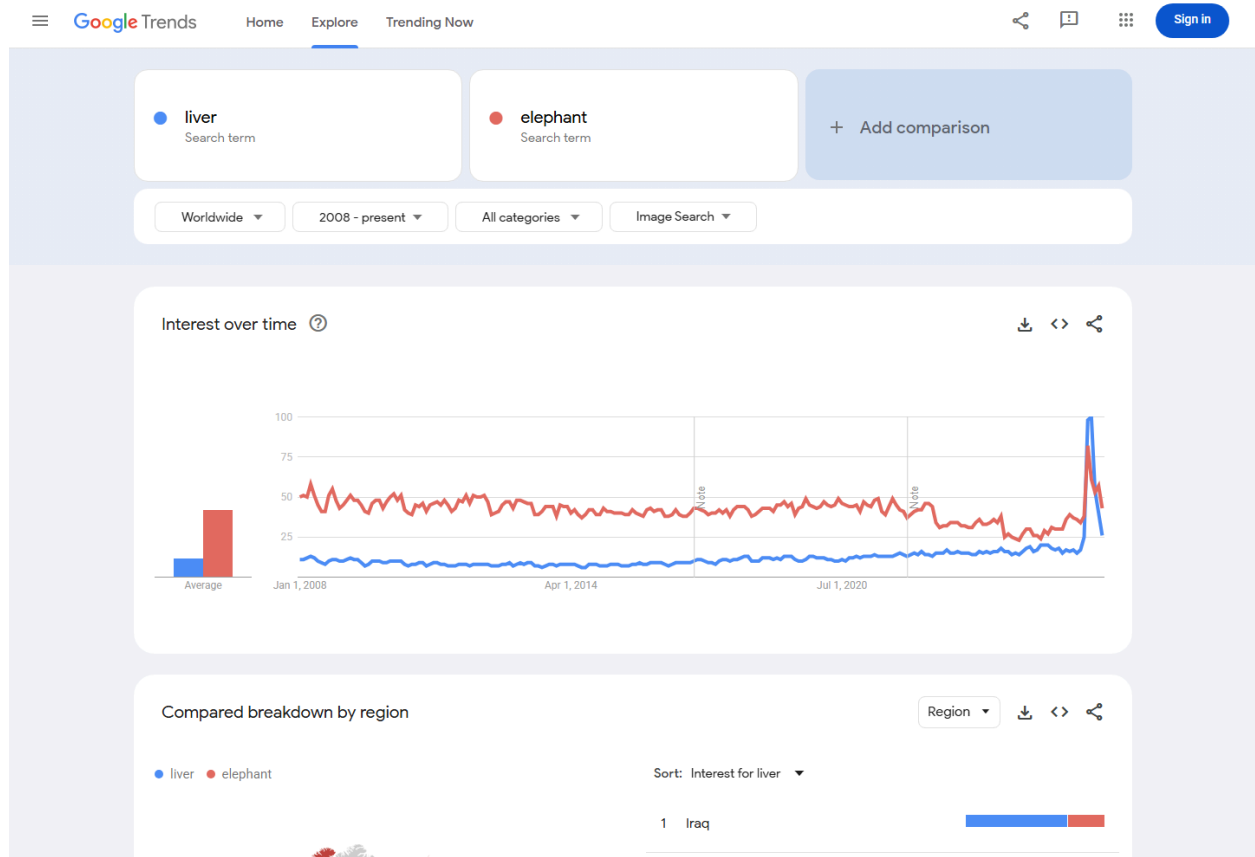
Query: <https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all&q=liver%2Celephant>



Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-07-21 using Worldwide, 2008-present, All categories, and Image Search. Liver trails elephant in the chart's long-run relative search interest. The recent endpoint is provisional and is not used as a trend claim.

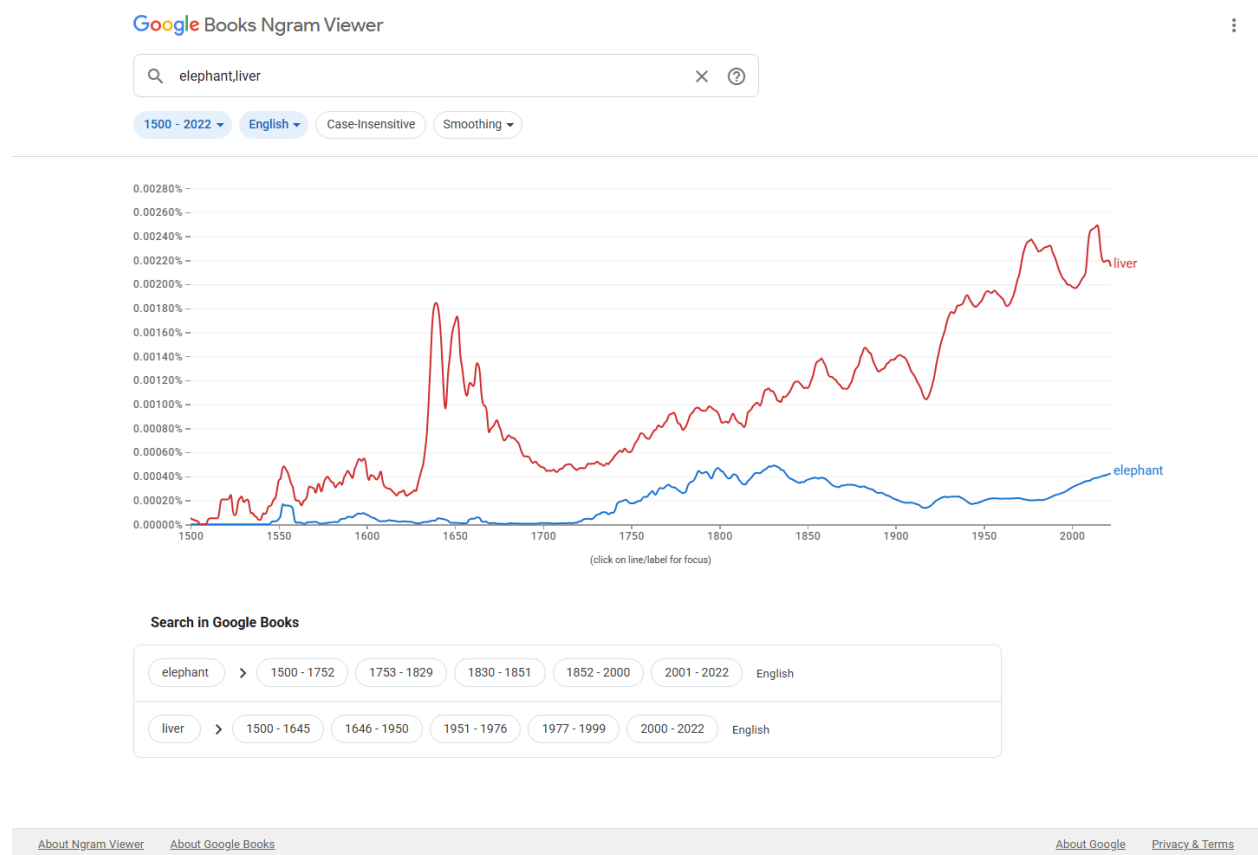
Query: https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all_2008&gprop=images&q=liver,elephant



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-21 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, case-sensitive matching, and smoothing 3. The widest available range shows liver above elephant in recent published-book usage and a durable record across centuries.

Query: https://books.google.com/ngrams/graph?content=elephant%2Cliver&year_start=1500&year_end=2022&corpus=en&smoothing=3



The 2026 captures were obtained in an unsigned browser session. Full URLs, dates, ranges, locations, modes, filters, and visible result-count behavior are recorded above and in the evidence notes.

F. Completeness

Not applicable. Liver is not offered to complete a finite anatomy set.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. No legacy-carrier or high-frequency system pictograph is claimed.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already representable

No existing emoji or sequence identifies the liver. Stomach and Anatomical Heart name different organs. Cut of Meat and Beans would shift the message toward food and remain visually and semantically ambiguous. Generic medical or organ imagery cannot distinguish liver from another body part. A sequence can add context only after the organ itself is identifiable.

B. Overly specific

No. Liver names the whole organ category, not a disease, procedure, specialty, cell type, segment, campaign, brand, or exact depiction. The proposal does not ask for liver disease, transplant, donation, cuisine, or any other narrower context as a separate character.

C. Open-ended

No. This proposal stands on the literal word's own frequency evidence, a distinct organ identity, and a specific gap that existing emoji cannot fill. It does not claim that an anatomy set is incomplete, and it does not treat Liver as precedent for adding every internal organ. A future organ candidate would need to establish its own literal frequency, non-substitutability, and a recognizable visual paradigm; it cannot rely on Liver's case. This submission is limited to a whole-organ reference that resolves the concrete body-site ambiguity described above, not to a taxonomy expansion.

D. Transient

No. The 1500-2022 Ngram comparison provides a long historical record for the literal word rather than a short-lived campaign or event. The proposal makes no claim based on a temporary disease, awareness drive, or news cycle.

E. Faulty comparison

No. The existence or importance of Anatomical Heart, Lungs, Brain, or any other emoji does not justify Liver. The independent case is the literal term's frequency, the remaining semantic gap, and a testable visual paradigm.

Other Information

Vendors should preserve a wide asymmetric outline, unequal lobes, and either a visible lower notch or a small gallbladder cue. Fine vessels, labels, and realistic surface anatomy are unnecessary and may reduce clarity at 18x18.

Official Unicode proposal guidance: <https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>